Meeting Minutes: Client Demand Communication & Requirement Confirmation for Author's Workbench

1. Meeting Basic Information

- **Meeting Theme**: In-depth communication with the client on core product positioning, functional demands, usage rules and follow-up development requirements of the novel plotting tool
- **Meeting Time**: 2026-08-19 10:30 - 11:05
- **Attendees**: Imbi (Client), Angelina, Yawen, Mackenzie, Warren, Ruting
- **Meeting Purpose**: Based on the team's prototype demonstration and requirement presentation, fully listen to and confirm the client's core product positioning, functional optimization suggestions, tool integration priorities and AI usage specifications, and unify all follow-up development standards centering on client demands

2. Core Client Product Positioning Definition

This meeting confirmed the **most critical product positioning** proposed explicitly by the client, which defines the core development logic of the entire tool:

The tool is positioned as a **plotting tool** rather than a novel writing tool. It only undertakes the functions of story planning, structure layout, chapter plotting and plot beat mapping. The formal manuscript writing work will not be completed in this tool.

Based on this positioning, the client clarified the standard user workflow: All preliminary story plotting and structural planning are completed in this tool. After the plotting work is finalized, users export the complete plan to Scrivener, which serves as the only official base for subsequent novel writing. Minor plot adjustments during writing do not require updating the plotting tool; only major structural and plot revisions need re-planning in the tool.

3. Client's Prototype Feedback & Functional Optimization Demands

The team displayed the initial product prototype and sorted out the preliminary

functional logic. The client gave targeted modification and optimization suggestions based on core plotting scenarios, which are the key revised requirements for subsequent iterations:

3.1 Mandatory Functional Optimization Requirements Proposed by Client

- **Optimize Chapter Page Display Logic**: The client clearly pointed out that the original chapter word count display is of low practical value for a plotting tool. It is required to replace the word count display with a **one-sentence core plot summary** for each chapter, allowing authors to quickly identify key plot content at a glance and improve plotting efficiency.
- **Realize Two-way Synchronization of Character-chapter Association**: The client demanded adding a quick character addition button in the chapter view. When users associate characters with a chapter, the system shall automatically synchronize the chapter's plot participation information to the corresponding character profile, realizing bidirectional data linkage to facilitate overall story character management.

3.2 Client's Long-term Iteration Requirement

The client put forward a personalized custom function demand for future product updates: support **custom story structure creation**. Users can independently set the percentage position of core plot beats based on classic film and television story structures or their original creation logic to generate exclusive personalized plotting templates, adapting to diverse creative habits.

4. Client's Confirmed Third-party Tool Integration Priority

Aiming at the tool's external export and docking function, the client clearly defined the development priority based on real user usage scenarios, overriding the team's preliminary assumed scheme:

4.1 Primary Priority: Excel Export Function

The client emphasized that Excel export shall be the core priority function. Excel has strong universality and flexible data editing and viewing attributes, covering the usage needs of most writers. The tool needs to support one-click export of all core plotting data including chapter plans, plot summaries and beat distribution.

4.2 Secondary Priority: Scrivener Export Function

The client pointed out that Scrivener has complex operation logic and not all creators use this software. Thus, Scrivener export is defined as a secondary optional function. It will be developed and optimized only after the Excel export function is fully

launched and stable.

5. Client’s Clear Definition of AI Usage Boundary

This meeting finalized the strict AI application specification proposed by the client, which is an unchangeable core rule for product development:

5.1 Strict Prohibition on AI Participating in User-side Creative Work

The client clearly stated the core stance of the writing community: **original stories must be human-generated, and AI-generated plots and stories are not accepted**. Therefore, the tool shall never launch any AI-assisted plotting or AI automatic writing functions for end users. All story creation and plotting links are purely manually operated by authors to ensure the originality of literary creation.

5.2 Permitted AI Auxiliary Scenarios for Development Side

The client has no objection to the development team using AI tools for internal non-creative work. The team can use AI to assist UI design, code development, bug troubleshooting, data processing and other auxiliary development work to improve project efficiency, which does not conflict with user-side original creation rules.